

abroad was that the Jew Erwin Phillips, President of the Austrian Dynamit A.G., had come down from Prague to attend that very meeting at Schmitz' request. So, the policy of leaving "politically reliable men abroad" must have been window-dressing for the authorities.

Mr. Phillips was no longer alive to state whether he enjoyed himself in Berlin. Besides presiding over the Austrian firm from Prague, he directed its financial affairs as an officer of the Czech National Bank. On Haeffliger's earlier trips to Vienna, Max Ilgner went along, and they talked of Phillips' interest in Skodawerke Wetzler's sprawling dynamite factories outside Vienna. So, their hearts had been in Prague for a long time. Phillips was not only the key power in all the Austrian chemical industries, but the leading executive of all the Czech Nobel firms, and Ilgner had actually put on paper years before a plan to capture the dynamite and explosives industries of both Austria and Czechoslovakia. A year before ANSCHLUSS, the Commercial Committee had approved Ilgner's idea of training men in the Farben plants to be ready "at any time to go to Austria." This suggestion had been executed through the VW. Perhaps Haeffliger, comparing his own role to Ilgner's, and to von Schnitzler's discussions with Mueller, the biggest munitions mogul on the Continent, felt that his trips to Vienna were "odd jobs." He and Ilgner were trying to accomplish in one country, Austria, what had been planned for two countries. Failing to capture the parent, they would capture the children. Was this one answer to the question how Carl Krauch, a mere chemical scientist, began to smell of gunpowder?

But even after Mr. Phillips was murdered in Prague, Ilgner and Haeffliger met resistance from the local managers. Interrogated in the Nurnberg jail, Haeffliger had told of their first capture, SKODAWERKE WETZLER: "I was advised 'that Mr. Johan had not been willing in the past to part with the majority of these shares.' However, time was evidently working for Dr. Ilgner. With the fast growing, in fact, revolutionary unrest in Austria, the completion of the deal must have become very